

PORT AHOY Cargo ship at Vallarpadam container terminal, Kochi

ALAMY

AT THE CURRENT GROWTH RATE, INDIA WILL NEED 75 YEARS TO REACH A QUARTER OF AMERICA'S PER CAPITA INCOME, ACCORDING TO A RECENT WORLD BANK REPORT. IT NEEDS TO GROW MUCH FASTER

in energy, $2 trillion would be for clean energy technologies and infrastructure. India has announced big plans and said that the country will see an investment of Rs 30 lakh crore to meet its target of 500 GW of renewable energy by 2030. This needs steadfast implementation.

India has moved much ahead in its quest to build digital infrastructure, thanks to the high proliferation of mobile phones and the internet, but more needs to be done to ensure better pan-India connectivity so that the benefits of technology seep down to the most deserving. What India lacks, says Garg, is technology innovation. That leaves us with the need to import technology. "However, we have some policy cobwebs. For instance, we will not cooperate with China, or allow Chinese investment to come in." That sets us back by several years, he adds. China, on the other hand, is capturing the world market with its products. For instance, in electric vehicles, it has an 85 per cent market share, while India's share is just 2 per cent. Sports, travel, entertainment and personal services (captured in the acronym 'STEPS') will be the drivers of growth in the future.

↘ **Improve efficiency:** Joshi believes that what drives growth in the long run are capital (investments), the quality and quantity of labour, and efficiency. Efficiency will play a more important role than in the past because when physical infrastructure is created, connectivity improves and turnaround time gets reduced. He advocates the need to push through reforms in land and labour to improve ease of doing business. "Reforms are very critical from the point of view of running a growth marathon. How quickly the country moves will determine how fast it will grow," he says.

The next two decades to 100 years of India's independence will be a race that will test the country's resilience in some very challenging times. If it can leverage its human capital to take a growth leap, India will ensure better opportunity and more prosperity to the millions of its citizens. ■